

Protecting your code from prying eyes

If you write JavaScript code within your Web page itself, anyone can see what you've done just by right-clicking on the page and selecting "View Source" (the actual command changes from browser to browser).

If you don't want visitors seeing the code you've written, you can write it in an external file, and point your Web page to that file from within the `<script>` tags. Let's assume we're writing JavaScript for `www.samplesite.com`. This is how you would include an external JavaScript file:

```
<html>
<head>
...
<script src="/scripts/sample.js"
type="text/javascript"></script>
</head>

<body>
...
</body>
</html>
```

"sample.js" is the file that contains all your JavaScript code. Notice that the path to it is an http path with forward slashes. The full path to it will be `www.samplesite.com/scripts/sample.js`. To prevent visitors to your site getting their hands on this file, just disable read access on the "scripts" folder when you upload the site—more on this in Chapter 10.

Declaring Variables

Variables in JavaScript can be declared by using the "var" statement thus:

```
var a
OR
```